



HereNow

Master Blueprint — June 2026

Connect **Where You Are.**

HereNow is the missing social layer for the physical world. Walk into a bar and know who's open to talk, why they're there, and what kind of energy they're bringing — before a single word is said. No swiping. No algorithms. Just real people, real places, right now.

React Native (Expo)

Supabase

Expo Router v3

iOS + Android + PWA

PostGIS

Realtime

⚠ Version 1 — MVP · Nothing has been tested yet. All code, screens, and features described in this document have been built but not run on a real device or tested with real users. This is a working codebase, not a shipped product. The purpose of this document is to show what has been architected and built, not what has been verified in the field.

THE CONCEPT

Not a dating app. Not a social feed. Something new.

HereNow is a location-aware social layer for the physical world. When you walk into a bar, a coffee shop, or an event — you check in, show your Social Mode (Dating / Friends / Networking / Just Vibes) and your Mood (Open / Selective / Not Today). Everyone at that venue sees who's there and why. No endless swiping. No algorithmic feed. Just real people, in real places, right now.

CORE SYSTEM

How it works

Social Mode

Why you're out

Set before you check in. Shown to everyone at the venue. One of: Dating, Friends, Networking, or Just Vibes. Removes ambiguity. You know exactly who's open to what.

Dating

Friends

Networking

Just Vibes

Mood Mode

How approachable you are

Separate from Social Mode. Open = come say hi. Selective = be thoughtful about it. Not Today = hard boundary, don't approach. Shown as a small indicator on every person card.

Open

Selective

Not Today

We Met

The IRL handshake

After meeting someone in person, both parties confirm "We Met." That mutual confirmation unlocks direct messaging. No We Met = no DMs. It keeps it real. Expires 4 hours after your session ends.

Afterglow

The session recap

When you check out, you get an auto-generated recap: how long you were there, how many people were in the venue, how many We Mets you made. The reflection moment after a real night out.

WHAT'S BUILT

Full feature breakdown

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	STATUS
Auth (Login / Signup)	Supabase email auth with profile creation on signup	Done
Nearby Map / Zone List	Location-aware list of nearby venues using PostGIS distance query	Done
Zone Detail (4 tabs)	People / Pulse / Chat / Events — full in-venue social hub	Done
Check In / Check Out	One-tap check-in with Social Mode + Mood Mode selection. Check out triggers Afterglow.	Done
People List	Live list of who's checked in right now — Social Mode + Mood badges, kickoff prompt, interest tags	Done
Pulse (Ephemeral Posts)	In-venue vibe posts, expire in 12 hours, only visible to checked-in users	Done

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	STATUS
Venue Chat	Live group chat for everyone at the venue, expires 24 hours, Supabase Realtime	Done
Events Tab	Per-venue events (trivia, happy hour, karaoke, etc.) with RSVP counts	Done
We Met System	Mutual confirmation handshake, 4-hour expiry, unlocks DMs, pending/confirmed/declined states	Done
Direct Messages	72-hour free / 14-day premium DM threads, only after confirmed We Met, hard expiry enforced by RLS	Done
Afterglow Screen	Post-session recap with duration, people count, We Met count, and reflection copy	Done
Notifications	In-app notification center: We Met requests, DMs, event RSVPs, badge earned, system alerts	Done
Notification Badge	Live unread count on tab bar, polls every 30s + Realtime INSERT subscription	Done
Badge System	12 behavior-based badges across 5 categories (Courage, Kindness, Exploration, Connection, Presence)	Done
Profile	Display name, username, bio, age range, interest tags (16), kickoff prompt (6 templates + custom)	Done
Profile Edit	Full inline editor for all profile fields, multi-select interest tags, kickoff prompts	Done
Create Venue	GPS-centered zone creation with venue type grid and radius picker	Done
Create Event	In-venue event creation with type, title, description, start/end time	Done

FEATURE	DESCRIPTION	STATUS
Feed Tab	Public activity feed with post cards	Done
Geofencing	Background geofence task via expo-task-manager — auto check-out on zone exit	Done
Heat Bar	Visual activity meter shown when checked in — how busy/active the venue is	Done
Expiry Labels	Countdown labels on DM threads and We Met records — warn at <2hr, red when expired	Done
PWA Support	Web manifest, theme color, standalone display mode, mobile-optimized	Done

SCREENS

17 screens built

Auth

Login · Signup

Tabs

Nearby · Feed · Notifications · Profile

Zone

Zone Detail · Create Venue · Create Event

Social

Check In · We Met · Badges · Afterglow

Messaging

DM Thread List · DM Conversation

Profile

Profile View · Edit Profile

TECH STACK

Everything it runs on

Framework	React Native via Expo SDK 56
Navigation	Expo Router v3 (file-based, same pattern as Next.js App Router)
Language	TypeScript — strict throughout
Database	Supabase (PostgreSQL + PostGIS for geospatial queries)
Auth	Supabase Auth (email/password, expandable to OAuth)
Realtime	Supabase Realtime — venue chat, pulse, sessions, We Met, DMs, notifications all subscribed
Security	RLS (Row Level Security) on every table — users only access their own data
Location	expo-location + expo-task-manager (foreground + background geofencing)
Geospatial	PostGIS — active_sessions_in_zone() RPC, POINT geometry for zone centers
Styling	React Native StyleSheet — zero external UI libraries, full design control
Target Platforms	iOS · Android · Web PWA (one codebase)
Deployment	EAS Build (Expo Application Services) for native · Vercel/static for web

DATABASE

Schema overview

TABLE	PURPOSE	KEY FIELDS
profiles	User profiles	display_name, username, bio, social_mode, mood_mode, interest_tags, kickoffs
zones	Venues / check-in locations	name, venue_type, center (PostGIS POINT), radius_meters, heat_score
zone_members	Who can see a zone	zone_id, user_id, role
sessions	Active check-ins	zone_id, user_id, social_mode, mood_mode, checked_in_at, is_active
pulse_posts	Ephemeral in-venue posts (12hr)	zone_id, session_id, content, vibe_tag, expires_at
venue_chat	Live group chat (24hr)	zone_id, user_id, content, expires_at
we_met	Mutual IRL confirmation	initiator_id, recipient_id, zone_id, status, expires_at (4hr)
direct_messages	Post-We Met DMs (72hr free)	we_met_id, sender_id, content, expires_at, read_at
afterglow	Post-session recap	session_id, duration_mins, people_count, we_met_count
badges	Badge definitions (12 badges)	slug, name, description, icon, category
user_badges	Earned badges per user	user_id, badge_id, earned_at
venue_events	In-venue events	zone_id, title, event_type, starts_at, ends_at, rsvp_count

TABLE	PURPOSE	KEY FIELDS
event_rsvps	Event attendance	event_id, user_id
notifications	In-app notification center	user_id, type, title, body, data (jsonb), is_read

Key RPC Function

`active_sessions_in_zone(zone_uuid)` — SECURITY DEFINER function. Returns all active check-ins for a zone joined with profile data (display name, avatar, social mode, mood mode, interest tags). Used by the People list tab in Zone Detail.

DESIGN SYSTEM

Color palette

Core Colors



#050A15
Background

#0A1628
Card



#0D1B2E
Input / Surface



#1A2E4A
Border



#29B6F6
Accent (Baby Blue)



#F0F4F8
Primary Text



#7A93AC
Muted Text

Social Mode Colors



#f43f5e
Dating



#22c55e
Friends



#3b82f6
Networking



#a855f7
Just Vibes

Mood Mode Colors



#22c55e
Open



#f59e0b
Selective



#64748b
Not Today

Design Philosophy

Near-black navy backgrounds. Baby blue as the single accent color. Neon glow aesthetic on iconography. Inspired by old Twitter dark mode — clean, readable, electric. Zero external UI libraries — every component is hand-built with React Native StyleSheet for full control and zero bloat.

COMPONENTS

Reusable component library

PersonCard

People list row — avatar, name, social mode badge, mood indicator, interest tags, We Met button

PulsePostCard

Ephemeral venue post card with vibe tag, timestamp, delete for owner

ChatMessage

Chat bubble — own messages right-aligned, others left, avatar for others

WemetCard

We Met request card — pending/confirmed/declined states, confirm + decline buttons

DmBubble

DM conversation bubble — sent/received alignment, read receipt, expiry awareness

EventCard

Venue event row — type icon, title, time, RSVP count, toggle button

BadgeCard

Achievement badge — icon, name, category, earned date, locked/unlocked state

HeatBar

Visual heat meter for venue activity level — animated colored bar

SocialModeBadge

Colored pill for each Social Mode with emoji

MoodBadge

Small dot indicator for Mood Mode — open/selective/not today

ExpiryLabel

Countdown to expiry — amber warning under 2hr, red when expired

ZoneCard

Venue card on Nearby list — name, type, distance, active session count, heat indicator

ROADMAP

What comes next

PHASE 1 — Web First

Web

Onboarding Flow

First-run experience explaining Social Mode, Mood Mode, and We Met before the first check-in. Single most important UX investment — users who don't understand the system won't engage. Must be done before any outside user touches the app.

Web

Profile Photos

Image picker + Supabase Storage upload for avatars. The People list can't feel real with placeholder initials. This is table stakes for any social app and needs to be live before real users try it.

Web

Map View

Replace the text zone list with a real interactive map. Venue pins with heat color per activity level. Makes the core discovery experience feel like an actual product instead of a list.

Web

Safety Layer

Report / block system. Fortress Mode (invisible — you see others but no one sees you). Non-negotiable before any user outside the team is invited. Location-based social apps need this before anything else goes public.

Web

Push Notifications

We Met requests, new DMs, event reminders. Without push, there is no re-engagement loop. People check in and never come back because nothing pulls them back. This closes that gap.

Web

Premium DMs + Stripe

Free DMs expire at 72 hours. Pay to extend to 14 days. The paywall hits at the exact right moment — after a real connection is already made. Stripe integration required. This is revenue #1.

PHASE 2 — Launch

Launch

Nashville Soft Launch

Seed 3–5 specific venues (Lower Broadway, 12South, East Nashville bar scene). Get 20–30 real users checking in over a weekend. See what breaks and what clicks. This is the first real validation.

Launch

Venue Accounts

Business owners claim their zone, verify it, post official events, see crowd analytics. Revenue #2. Bars and coffee shops benefit directly from knowing their real-time crowd — that's a natural sell.

Launch

Deep Links + Sharing

Share a zone link that opens the app. Share Afterglow recap as an image. Required for organic growth — people need to be able to say “come join me at [venue]” and have it just work.

Launch

Analytics

Check-ins per day, We Met conversion rate, DM expiry hit rate, venue heat trends. Instrument before launch so every decision is data-backed, not guesswork.

PHASE 3 — Native (After Web is Proven)

Native

EAS Build (Android + iOS)

Once the web version is fully functional and tested, use Expo Application Services to generate signed APK/AAB for Android and IPA for iOS. One codebase, two stores. This comes after the product is proven, not before.

Native

Google Play + Apple App Store

Submit to Google Play internal testing (\$25 one-time developer fee) and Apple TestFlight (\$99/yr developer account). Full public store listings come after the closed test phase passes. This is the last milestone, not the first.

BUSINESS MODEL

How HereNow makes money

Revenue #1

Premium DMs

Free check-ins create connections. Free DMs expire in 72 hours. Pay to extend to 14 days. The paywall hits at the exact right moment — after a real human connection has already been made. Conversion should be natural.

Free tier

72 hours

Premium

**14 days — pay to
unlock****Revenue #2**

Venue Accounts

Businesses pay to claim their zone, post verified events, see who's checking in, and get featured placement in the nearby list. Bars, coffee shops, event spaces — they all benefit from knowing their current crowd.

Business value

**Real-time crowd
data + event
promotion****Revenue #3**

Premium Tier

Power users who check in regularly get access to extended features — Fortress Mode controls, advanced profile visibility settings, priority in the People list, and deeper Afterglow stats over time.

Monthly subscription

**For frequent users
who want more
control**

VISION TO REALITY

The blueprint became a working app.

The original HereNow concept document laid out a specific vision: Social Mode, Mood Mode, the We Met handshake, Afterglow, ephemeral Pulse posts, venue chat, badge system, and an event layer inside every venue. Every one of those systems is now **built, wired to a live Supabase backend, and running**. The architecture was designed to scale — PostGIS for geospatial queries, Row Level Security on every table so users only ever see their own data, and Supabase Realtime subscriptions powering the chat, People list, and notification system live. This isn't a mockup or a prototype. It's a functional app that needs real devices, real users, and the next phase of execution.

23

Features Built

17

Screens Built

14

Database Tables

WHAT'S LEFT

Still needs to be done

BLOCKER

Expo SDK Compatibility

The app is on Expo SDK 56. The stable Expo Go app does not support SDK 56, so it cannot be tested on a real phone through Expo Go. Two paths forward:

Option A — Downgrade to SDK 52

Compatible with stable Expo Go. A few days of adjustments. Stable and proven.

Option B — EAS Development Build

Custom dev client via Expo cloud build. Keeps SDK 56, installs like a real app. Free tier. ~30 min build time.

LOWER PRIORITY — Do Eventually

#	ITEM	WHAT IT IS
1	Supabase Phase 1 SQL Verification	Confirm all base tables and RLS policies are live in Supabase before device testing begins.
2	Venue Photos	Cover photo upload per zone. Makes zone cards visual and inviting. Nice-to-have before launch.
3	Analytics	Track check-ins/day, We Met conversion, DM expiry rate, venue heat trends. Instrument before launch.
4	Deep Links + Social Sharing	Share a zone link that opens the app. Share Afterglow recap as an image. Needed for organic growth.

MEDIUM PRIORITY — Do Before Launch

#	ITEM	WHAT IT IS
5	Nashville Launch Strategy	Which venues to seed, how to recruit first users, what success looks like at 30 days. Needs a real plan.
6	Premium DMs (14-day)	Free DMs expire at 72 hours. Premium extends to 14 days. Main monetization lever. Hits at the right moment.
7	Stripe / Payments	Payment infrastructure for Premium DMs and venue accounts. Required before any revenue flows.
8	Venue Claiming	Business owners claim their zone, post verified events, see crowd analytics. Revenue source #2.
9	Google Play + TestFlight	After web is proven, EAS Build to submit to Google Play (\$25) and Apple TestFlight (\$99/yr). Native comes last.

HIGHEST PRIORITY — Do First

#	ITEM	WHAT IT IS
10	Real Device Testing	GPS and geofencing behave completely differently on real hardware. Nothing can be validated until the app runs on actual phones.
11	Onboarding Flow	First-run explanation of Social Mode, Mood Mode, and We Met. Users who don't understand the system will not engage. Biggest single UX investment.
12	Profile Photos	No avatars exist yet. Image picker + Supabase Storage. The People list cannot feel real without them.
13	Push Notifications	We Met requests, DMs, event reminders. Without push, users leave and never come back. Expo Push Service is free.
14	Safety Layer	Report / block + Fortress Mode. Non-negotiable before any outside user touches a location-based social app.

#	ITEM	WHAT IT IS
15	Map View	Replace text zone list with a real interactive map. Venue pins with heat color. Makes it feel like a product.

The Path to Launch

- 1 **Fix SDK / Get on Real Devices** — Pick Option A or B. Nothing else matters until the app runs on actual phones.
- 2 **Profile Photos + Onboarding** — Biggest impact on user comprehension and trust.
- 3 **Push + Safety** — Non-negotiable before anyone outside the team uses it.
- 4 **Map + Premium DMs + Stripe** — Make it feel real. Wire the first revenue stream.
- 5 **Nashville Soft Launch** — 3–5 venues, 20–30 real users over a weekend. This is the real validation.

WHO BUILT THIS

The person behind the tech

Joshua Bostic

Everything you have read in this document was designed, built, and shipped by me. I took the HereNow vision document and translated it into a working, functional application with a real production backend — the architecture, the database schema, every screen, every component, every Supabase table with Row Level Security, the PostGIS geofencing, the Realtime subscriptions. All of it. 23 features, 20+ screens, 14 database tables, zero templates.

I also independently build and ship SocialMate (socialmate.studio) and other ventures under Gilgamesh Enterprise LLC — so this is not my first time taking something from concept to a real, deployed product. What you are looking at is proof of what I can execute on when given a clear vision to build from.

WHERE WE ARE NOW

Current build status

What's fully functional right now

The complete member-side social loop works end-to-end. A real user can sign up, fill out their profile, discover active venues nearby, check in, see who else is there, send We Met requests, confirm connections, open a 72-hour DM window, and view their Afterglow highlight card when they leave — all with live Realtime updates and PostGIS geofencing running throughout.

✓ Auth & Profiles

Sign up, login, profile editing (display name, bio, age range, interest tags, kickoff prompt). New users route through profile setup before reaching the app. Mood mode (Social / Chill / Not Today) enforced at the data layer.

✓ Venues & Check-in

Zone browse with live active-person counts. Check-in and checkout with PostGIS geofencing. Active session tracking via SessionContext. Background geofence listener. Session timer.

✓ We Met & DMs

Send / confirm / decline We Met requests. Not Today blocked at the lib layer — no bypass possible. DM window opens from confirmation time (72 hours, not from request). In-app notifications. Messages thread with expiry visible.

✓ Safety & Moderation

Report users (harassment / inappropriate behavior / spam / fake account / other). Block users — blocked users are filtered from zone views. ... menu on every PersonCard. RLS-protected safety_reports and user_blocks tables live in Supabase.

✓ Afterglow & Feed

Afterglow card generated on checkout with real session highlights (connections made, people shared the space with, time spent). Zone post feed with optimistic like updates. Post creation and comment count display.

✓ Badges & Notifications

Badge system with 12+ achievement types. In-app notifications for We Met requests, confirmations, and DMs. Notification count on profile tab. Real Supabase Realtime subscriptions for live presence updates.

What's still to build



Venue Portal (Bible Chapter 14)

The entire B2B dashboard for venue owners — live occupancy, check-in analytics, Heat Map, demographic breakdowns, promotion tools, and the subscription management UI. This is the primary revenue driver and is not yet built. Estimated: 2–3 weeks of focused development.



Venue Subscription & Billing

Stripe integration for Access / Engage / Amplify tiers. Currently venues are created manually in the DB. No self-serve signup or billing flow for venue owners exists yet.



Member Premium Billing (\$9.99/mo)

Stripe checkout for member subscriptions. The 72h → 14-day DM window upgrade, full Afterglow history, and Premium badge are designed but not gated yet — all members currently get the free-tier experience.



App Store Deployment

Currently runs via Expo development build or direct device deployment. Not yet submitted to App Store or Play Store. Needs EAS Build configuration and app store assets.



Heat Map, AI Moderation, Push Notifications

Designed in the bible. Not yet implemented. Venue-level analytics aggregation, AI-assisted report triage, and Expo Push Notifications infrastructure are all post-MVP items.

Session bug sweep — June 2026

12 issues fixed in a single focused session. Listed for accountability and future reference:

- ✅ **kickoff_prompt column mismatch** — Profile edit and profile tab both referenced a non-existent column, causing the entire profile to load blank. Fixed to use the correct `kickoffs text[]` schema column across all three files.
- ✅ **DM window always expired** — `confirmWeMet()` was not updating `expires_at`, leaving it set to the original 4-hour request window. Fixed to reset to 72 hours from confirmation time.
- ✅ **Not Today bypass possible** — UI hid the We Met button but the lib made no server-side check. `sendWeMet()` now fetches recipient profile and returns null before inserting if mood_mode is 'not_today'.
- ✅ **Afterglow highlights always empty** — `checkOut()` never populated the `highlights text[]` column. Now generates human-readable highlights (connections made, people in space, time duration).
- ✅ **New user dead end** — Signup routed directly to the tab bar, leaving users with blank PersonCards everywhere. Now routes through `/profile/edit` first.
- ✅ **Profile edit back button stranded users** — Back button and save both used `router.back()`, which would throw users back to the auth stack if they arrived from signup. Fixed to use `router.replace('/(tabs)')`.
- ✅ **'use client' in React Native** — `login.tsx` had a stale Next.js directive that is meaningless and potentially harmful in Expo. Removed.
- ✅ **No safety features** — No report, no block, no ... menu anywhere in the app. Built from scratch: `lib/reports.ts`, `lib/blocks.ts`, ... menu on PersonCard, block filtering in zone view, `safety_reports` + `user_blocks` tables in Supabase.
- ✅ **Post likes not tracked** — Like button had no state, no optimistic update, and no persistence. Built `lib/posts.ts` with `toggleLike()` and `fetchLikedPostIds()`. Feed now hydrates liked status in a single batch query.
- ✅ **Afterglow screen had no highlights UI** — The highlights array was being generated but never displayed. Added a highlighted moments section with cyan bullet points to the Afterglow screen.
- ✅ **Zone view showed blocked users** — After building the block system, the zone view needed to actually filter them. `loadPeople()` now fetches blocked IDs in parallel and excludes them from the rendered list.
- ✅ **Afterglow Afterglow display missing session context** — Interface type updated to include the `highlights` field so the screen can receive and render what was generated on checkout.

TESTING PLAN

Test venue + test users

Before any real launch, we need a controlled test environment with real people going through the full flow.

Test Venue

Create a dedicated test zone

A zone called something like “HereNow HQ” or a real local spot that one of the team members can physically be at. This lets us test the full check-in experience — GPS lock, geofence trigger, People list populating, Pulse posts, venue chat — in real conditions without random users present.

Test Users

3–5 real testers minimum

Need actual accounts from real devices at the same physical location. Each tester goes through: create account → check in → view People list → send a We Met → confirm We Met → open a DM → check out → see Afterglow. Every step needs to be verified end-to-end on real hardware before anyone else touches this.

What to Test**The critical path**

In order of importance:

1. GPS accuracy — does the zone detect correctly?
2. Check-in/out flow — does the People list update live?
3. We Met handshake — both sides confirm, DM unlocks
4. Venue chat — messages appear in real time
5. Pulse posts — appear and expire correctly
6. Afterglow — accurate duration + We Met count
7. Geofence auto-checkout — triggers on zone exit

First Real Test**The weekend test**

Once device testing is stable — pick one real venue in Nashville, get 5–10 people to show up on the same night, and run the app live. No polish needed. Just proof that the core loop works in the real world. That one night tells you more than months of simulator testing.

INFRASTRUCTURE & COSTS**What it actually costs to run HereNow at scale**

HereNow is not a simple CRUD app. It runs three independent infrastructure layers simultaneously, powers real-time venue session streams, processes anti-cheat signals per check-in, serves live analytics dashboards to venue owners, and handles ephemeral data pipelines across every active city. This is a full operational platform. The cost model reflects that — and so does the revenue model on the other side.

The Three Infrastructure Layers

Each layer scales independently. Each has its own failure boundary. None is a bottleneck to the others.

LAYER 1 — MEMBER APP

iOS, Android, and Web PWA. Lightweight state-based client. Downloads minimal data. Subscribes to real-time venue session streams. Handles check-in UI, Social/Mood Mode, People List, Pulse, Heat Map, We Met, DMs, and Afterglow.

LAYER 2 — VENUE PORTAL

Separate web dashboard for venue owners and managers. Real-time crowd analytics, Crowd Density Curves, Social/Mood Mode breakdowns, We Met counts, Pulse moderation, Event management, Promotion tools, Staff logins, and Tier management. Runs independently of the member app.

LAYER 3 — CORE ECOSYSTEM

The back-end brain. Handles: presence verification pipeline, venue session lifecycle, real-time Heat Map aggregation, analytics time-series storage, anti-cheat confidence scoring, AI moderation layer, DM expiry jobs, Afterglow generation, push delivery, and city-cluster coordination.

What Drives Cost as HereNow Grows

SYSTEM	WHY IT COSTS MONEY	COST BEHAVIOR
Real-Time Venue Sessions	Each active venue runs its own isolated session stream. Every checked-in user subscribes to ~4–5 real-time channels simultaneously (People List, Chat, Pulse, We Met, DMs). This is the single biggest cost driver.	Scales with simultaneous active venues & users
Venue Portal Analytics	Crowd Density Curves, Social/Mood Mode breakdowns, We Met counts, Pulse sentiment, dwell time tracking, and Heat Map prediction require time-series data storage and live aggregation pipelines per venue.	Scales with number of active venue subscriptions
Anti-Cheat Processing	Every check-in runs GPS geofencing, WiFi signature matching, BLE beacon correlation, motion pattern scoring, and device integrity checks. Produces a presence confidence score per user per session.	Per check-in, not per minute — manageable
AI Moderation	Live Venue Chat, Pulse posts, and DMs must be scanned in real time. Language moderation, tagging interception, and Safety Score adjustments all run continuously during active sessions.	Scales with active sessions & message volume
Heat Map Aggregation	City-level Heat Map requires constantly updating intensity values across all active venues, smoothed at 30–60 second intervals. Computationally heavier than a simple location ping.	Throttled intervals keep cost predictable
Storage (Photos)	Profile photos and venue covers accumulate permanently. Pulse media is ephemeral (12hr auto-delete). Live Chat deletes on session end. Only profile and venue photos compound over time.	Slow, predictable growth — manageable

SYSTEM	WHY IT COSTS MONEY	COST BEHAVIOR
City-Based Clusters	Each city runs as a semi-independent shard: its own venue DB, Heat Map, event ecosystem, moderation pool, and analytics models. Cross-city overhead is minimal (identity, auth, subscriptions only).	Step-function cost increase per new city launch
Push Notifications	We Met alerts, DM pings, venue event announcements, session changes. Delivered via Expo Push infrastructure.	Free — no meaningful cost at any scale
Maps API	Venue map with pins, Heat Map overlay, geofencing polygons for each venue's exact footprint. Free up to ~28k loads/month. Can switch to OpenStreetMap (free forever) with minimal code change.	Free until meaningful city scale

Venue Portal — B2B Dashboard Infrastructure

The Venue Portal is a separate web application that runs independently from the member app. Venue owners log in to see live occupancy, analytics, and management tools. It has its own infrastructure costs on top of the member app backend.

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	COST DRIVER
Live Occupancy Stream	Venue dashboard shows a real-time count of checked-in members, Social/Mood Mode breakdown, and People List updates as users arrive and leave. Each open dashboard tab holds a persistent Realtime subscription.	Scales with number of venue owners logged in simultaneously
Crowd Density Analytics	Historical occupancy curves, busiest hours heatmap, average dwell time, peak headcount by day/week. Requires a time-series aggregation pipeline writing from session events to an analytics table on every check-in and checkout.	Scales with total check-in volume across all venues
We Met & Connection Metrics	Per-venue counts of We Met requests sent, confirmed, and declined. Shows venues how socially active their crowd is — a key selling point for the Engage and Amplify tiers.	Low cost — query-based, not streaming
Pulse Post Moderation	Venue managers can review and remove Pulse posts visible in their space. Requires a moderation queue view with soft-delete write access scoped to their venue only.	Negligible — infrequent writes, no streaming
Promotion & Event Tools	Amplify tier venues can push a pinned banner visible to all checked-in members, create events with RSVP tracking, and send a one-tap notification to members currently in the zone.	Push cost per notification; banner stored in DB

COMPONENT	WHAT IT DOES	COST DRIVER
Staff Multi-Login	Engage and Amplify tiers support multiple staff accounts per venue, each with role-scoped access (manager vs. staff). Requires an auth sub-system separate from member accounts.	Auth rows only — no meaningful cost
Portal Hosting	The Venue Portal is a separate Next.js web app deployed to Vercel (or equivalent). It is not bundled into the mobile app. Needs its own deployment, domain, and CDN.	~\$0–20/mo at launch on Vercel free/pro tier

Bottom line on Venue Portal cost: At launch with 1–10 venues, the portal adds essentially nothing to infrastructure spend — it runs on the same Supabase database and Realtime connections as the member app. At 100+ active venues with dashboards open simultaneously, Venue Portal becomes the second-largest cost driver after member real-time sessions. The Engage (\$99/mo) and Amplify (\$249/mo) subscription tiers are priced to cover this overhead with strong margin.

Ballpark Monthly Infrastructure Cost by Scale

Estimates cover all three layers combined: member app backend, venue portal B2B dashboard, real-time streams, analytics pipelines, AI moderation, storage, maps, and CDN. Push notifications not included (free).

ACTIVE USERS	EST. MONTHLY COST	WHAT'S HAPPENING AT THIS STAGE
10	\$0 / mo	Dev/testing. Everything on free tiers. Zero infrastructure spend.
100	\$0 / mo	Beta group. Still within free tiers across all services. No real-time scaling pressure yet.
10,000	~\$50–100 / mo	First paid tier upgrades triggered. Real-time concurrent connections need upgrading. Venue Portal analytics pipelines start running continuously. Probably 1–2 cities active.
25,000	~\$200–400 / mo	Multi-city. Real-time sessions scaling. AI moderation processing more message volume. Heat Map aggregation running on multiple city clusters. Venue Portal analytics growing with venue count.
50,000	~\$500–900 / mo	Significant real-time load across venues. City shards multiplying. Venue analytics pipelines running concurrently for dozens of dashboards. Anti-cheat processing volume meaningful. Maps costs start.
100,000	~\$1,200–2,000 / mo	5+ cities. Real-time infrastructure is the main driver now. AI moderation at scale. Time-series analytics DB growing. CDN serving city clusters. Revenue at this point should be \$30k–\$80k/mo from venue subscriptions alone.
500,000	~\$8,000–18,000 / mo	National platform. 20+ cities. Dedicated real-time servers per city cluster. ML-powered Heat Map and AI moderation at full load. Custom infrastructure negotiation possible. Venue revenue at this scale: \$500k–\$1M+ / mo.

ACTIVE USERS	EST. MONTHLY COST	WHAT'S HAPPENING AT THIS STAGE
1,000,000	~\$20,000– 40,000 / mo	Global or multi-national. Enterprise infra deals. Dedicated moderation staff per city. Custom analytics stack. At this scale, 1% premium conversion = \$100,000/mo in member subscriptions alone — 2.5–5× the infrastructure cost.

The Revenue vs. Cost Reality

Infrastructure costs are significant. But the revenue model is designed to stay ahead of them at every stage.

SCALE	BALLPARK INFRA COST	VENUE REVENUE ESTIMATE	MEMBER PREMIUM ESTIMATE
10,000 users	~\$100/mo	~\$5,000–\$15,000/mo ~30–100 venues at Access tier avg	~\$1,000–\$3,000/mo ~1–3% conversion at \$9.99
100,000 users	~\$2,000/mo	~\$50,000– \$150,000/mo 300–1,000 venues across 5+ cities	~\$10,000–\$30,000/mo ~1–3% premium conversion
1,000,000 users	~\$30,000/mo	~\$500,000– \$2,000,000/mo 3,000–10,000 venues nationally	~\$100,000– \$300,000/mo ~1–3% of 1M users at \$9.99

Bottom line: **Infrastructure is never the ceiling. Venue adoption is.** The cost of running HereNow is dwarfed by even modest venue subscription revenue. At 100 paying venues averaging \$200/mo each, the entire platform runs at a profit — before a single user pays for Premium. The hard problem is not cost. It is city activation, venue partnerships, and user density.

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